

# CHAPTER ONE: "THE LAST PAGE ISN'T IN THE SCRIPT"

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Mockumentary Pilot: DRAFT

 **STATUS:** This is a reworked draft and NOT the start of our story. The real-world story begins only when the showrunner gives the word.

*March 12 – May 31, 2007*

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BLACK SCREEN.

TITLE CARD:

"The following footage was recorded between 2007 and 2019 by an independent documentary crew with access to the people who made it.

It was sealed under agreement with Marvel Studios and could not be shown until the story was finished."

CUT TO:

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## COLD OPEN

ARCHIVAL FOOTAGE – "BRAINIAC" (DISNEY CHANNEL), SEASON 2,  
EPISODE 7: "SCIENCE FAIR-Y TALE"  
ORIGINAL AIR DATE: OCTOBER 11, 1996

Grainy 4:3 video. Canned laugh track. A cardboard-and-tinfoil "robot suit" stands on a science fair table.

MARCUS HAYES, played by a 14-year-old MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (looks about 9), in a bow tie, presents it to three unimpressed JUDGES.

MARCUS (MARC-ANTHONY, 14)  
Ladies and gentlemen of the  
science community... one day,  
a man will fly in a suit of  
armor!

The helmet falls off and lands on a judge's foot.

JUDGE

Ow!

MARCUS

...Not today. But one day.

(LAUGH TRACK)

HARD CUT TO:

EXT. ALABAMA HILLS, LONE PINE, CALIFORNIA – "AFGHANISTAN"

CAVE SET – DAY

MONDAY, MARCH 12, 2007 – 6:47 AM PT

Handheld documentary camera. Wind. Real red rock. Real dust.

The MARK I, 90 pounds of hammered, bolted, practical steel, stands on a stand. Ugly on purpose.

A man in a torn, bloodstained tank top stands in front of it, eating a gas-station honey bun. It's MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK, 25. He looks 19.

He notices the camera, points at the suit, then at the lens.

MARC-ANTHONY

Eleven years. Called it.

He takes a bite of the honey bun.

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## **TALKING HEAD**

INT. PRODUCTION TRAILER – LONE PINE – DAY

LOWER THIRD: MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK

Actor, "Tony Stark" · Age 25

Still in costume. Fake blood on his collarbone. Legs pulled up in a folding chair like a kid.

MARC-ANTHONY

So my whole life I've been two things. I've been "the Brainiac kid," and then after the HBO special, I was "the Brainiac kid who says [BLEEP] on television."

(beat)  
Those are my two settings. Those  
are the only two things Hollywood  
thinks I am. Cute... and filthy.  
(grins)  
And to be fair, I'm very good  
at both.  
(the grin fades a little)  
I turned down eleven comedies  
last year. Eleven. One of them,  
I swear to God, I get hit in the  
[BLEEP] by a golf cart on the  
poster. That's the poster.  
That's the whole marketing  
campaign. My [BLEEP] and a golf  
cart.  
(beat)  
And then Kevin Feige calls and  
says, "Do you want to be Tony  
Stark?" And I said...  
(looks off, genuinely moved)  
...I said "[BLEEP] yes" so loud  
my grandmother heard it from  
across town. She called my mom  
to complain.

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## THE LEDGER: AGES ON DAY ONE (MONDAY, MARCH 12, 2007)

| Person              | Born         | Age                       |
|---------------------|--------------|---------------------------|
| Marc-Antony Bullock | Jan 5, 1982  | 25 ( <i>looks 19–20</i> ) |
| Tayia Boyd          | Feb 3, 1982  | 25 ( <i>looks 19</i> )    |
| Amond Baker         | Feb 10, 1982 | 25 ( <i>looks 19</i> )    |
| Kevin Feige         | June 2, 1973 | 33                        |
| Avi Arad            | Aug 1, 1948  | 58                        |
| Jon Favreau         | Oct 19, 1966 | 40                        |
| Don Cheadle         | Nov 29, 1964 | 42                        |
| Jeff Bridges        | Dec 4, 1949  | 57                        |
| Samuel L. Jackson   | Dec 21, 1948 | 58                        |
| Stan Lee            | Dec 28, 1922 | 84                        |

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## **MEDIA INSERT: THE TRADES**

**VARIETY** | *Monday, March 12, 2007*

**MARVEL UPS FEIGE TO PRODUCTION PREZ**

*Longtime Arad lieutenant takes the reins as indie studio's first self-financed pic, 'Iron Man,' begins lensing today.*

**THE HOLLYWOOD REPORTER** | *March 12, 2007*

**'IRON MAN' ROLLS: Marvel bets \$140M on the 'Brainiac' kid**

*Marc-Anthony Bullock, 25, suits up in his first dramatic studio lead. Analysts question whether a comic company can survive without a studio's safety net. "If 'Iron Man' misses, Marvel's collateral is Captain America," said one financier. "Imagine explaining that to shareholders."*

**DEADLINE HOLLYWOOD DAILY (Nikki Finke)** | *March 12, 2007, 9:14 PM PT*

**TOLDJA: Marvel's Beverly Hills skeleton crew is making a play**

*Sources say Maisel's Merrill Lynch money comes with 10 characters attached. Why is a company making ONE movie locking actors into NINE-picture deals? Somebody over the Mercedes dealership is thinking big. Or crazy.*

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## **SCENE 1**

EXT. ALABAMA HILLS — CAVE SET — CONTINUOUS

MONDAY, MARCH 12, 2007 — 7:02 AM PT

JON FAVREAU (40), director, baseball cap, walkie on his hip, circles the Mark I like it's a used car. Marc-Anthony knocks on the chest plate. CLANG.

MARC-ANTHONY

That's real.

FAVREAU

That's real.

MARC-ANTHONY

I'm going to be inside that.

FAVREAU

You said no stunt double. I wrote it down. I had it notarized.

MARC-ANTHONY

(grinning)

I say a lot of things at 6 AM.  
Yesterday I told a PA I'd name my  
firstborn after her. I meant it.  
I'm having like nine kids, Jon.  
Somebody's getting named Brenda.

The camera finds a young PA with a clipboard, BRENDA (22). She  
looks into the lens and mouths: "He's serious."

Marc-Anthony runs his hand along a weld seam. His face changes.

MARC-ANTHONY (CONT'D)

Tony built this in a cave. With  
scraps. With a box of scraps.  
If it looks like a stunt guy is  
in there, the whole movie's a  
lie.

FAVREAU

So you're in.

MARC-ANTHONY

Fourteen months, Jon. Fourteen  
months of golf carts.  
(knocks on the steel again)  
I'm in.

A STUNT COORDINATOR hustles over with a harness rig.

STUNT COORDINATOR

We rigged it for his weight plus  
ninety. Two guys on safety lines.  
If he goes down, he goes down  
slow.

MARC-ANTHONY

Story of my career. Child star  
to "where is he now" in slow  
motion.

A golf cart pulls up. Marc-Anthony flinches at it on reflex,  
then looks at the camera.

MARC-ANTHONY (CONT'D)

See? Trauma.

TAYIA BOYD (25, looks 19) climbs out in a Stark Industries  
blazer with a parka over it, holding two coffees. She hands  
one to Favreau and keeps the other.

MARC-ANTHONY (CONT'D)  
Where's mine?

TAYIA  
Pepper doesn't get Tony coffee  
until page forty.

MARC-ANTHONY  
(to Favreau)  
She's been doing this to me since  
we were nine.

TAYIA  
And you've been walking into it  
since you were nine.  
(sips; eyes the Mark I)  
Well. Welcome to the big leagues,  
Brainiac.

Favreau watches them. A small, pleased smile. He clicks his  
walkie.

FAVREAU  
(into walkie)  
Keep B-camera on those two. All  
day. Whenever they're talking.

He notices the DOCUMENTARY CAMERA doing the same thing.

FAVREAU (CONT'D)  
(to the doc camera)  
You too, apparently.

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## **TALKING HEAD**

INT. PRODUCTION TRAILER — LONE PINE — DAY

LOWER THIRD: TAYIA BOYD  
Actor, "Pepper Potts" · Age 25

Parka zipped up to her chin. Coffee still in hand.

TAYIA  
People ask what it's like working  
with Marc again. I've known him  
since "SPLAT!" We were nine. He  
ate a crayon on our first day for  
twenty dollars. He gave the  
twenty dollars to the boom guy

because the boom guy's kid had  
a birthday.  
(beat)  
That's him. That's the whole  
man. Disgusting, and the nicest  
person you'll ever meet.  
(sips coffee)  
I'm still not getting him coffee.

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## **TALKING HEAD**

INT. VIDEO VILLAGE TENT — LONE PINE — DAY

LOWER THIRD: JON FAVREAU  
Director, "Iron Man" • Age 40

FAVREAU  
The studio's question was, "Can  
the Brainiac kid carry a \$140  
million movie?" And I said, have  
you WATCHED "Brainiac"? That kid  
was carrying a Disney Channel  
sitcom at thirteen with a laugh  
track and a talking robot dog.  
The robot dog was terrible, and  
he made it work.  
(beat)  
Tony Stark is the smartest,  
funniest guy in the room, and  
he's hiding something. That's  
Marc. I didn't cast an actor.  
I cast a guy.

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## **MEDIA INSERT: THE FANS**

SUPERHEROHYPE.COM FORUMS › *Iron Man (2008)* › "PRINCIPAL PHOTOGRAPHY BEGINS —  
DISCUSSION THREAD"

*Page 1 of 47*

**ShellHead\_1963** — *Mar 12 2007, 10:02 AM*

IT'S HAPPENING. Marc-Anthony Bullock is Tony. I've said it since the announcement in September. The man played a genius for four years on Brainiac, he has an actual engineering degree, and he's the funniest person alive. Casting of the decade.

**XxWolverineXx** — *Mar 12 2007, 10:09 AM*

lol ok. B-list hero, a Disney Channel kid whose last movie was a frat comedy, and a studio that's never made a movie. See you at the \$90M opening. Domestic TOTAL.

**PepperPottsFanClub** — *Mar 12 2007, 10:14 AM*

TAYIA BOYD AS PEPPER. Marcus and Keisha from Brainiac are BACK. If you watched that show you already know these two have the best comic timing on the planet. I'm not even worried.

**XxWolverineXx** — *Mar 12 2007, 10:16 AM*

@PepperPottsFanClub "I'm not even worried" is what my cousin said about Batman & Robin.

**Rhodey4WarMachine** — *Mar 12 2007, 10:31 AM*

Don Cheadle as Rhodey. Hotel Rwanda Don Cheadle. Pay attention to him. Mark my words, we see the silver suit by the sequel.

**ExcelsiorFaithful** — *Mar 12 2007, 11:47 AM*

Only thing I care about: IS IT COMIC ACCURATE? Stane better BE Iron Monger. Don't give me some made-up villain.

**Mjolnir\_Worthy** — *Mar 12 2007, 12:20 PM*

Weird question. Marvel ALSO has Hulk shooting this summer, and the rumor is Amond Baker for Banner. Amond Baker. Marc-Anthony's best friend since they were five. Two movies, same year, same studio. Anyone else think they're connected?

**XxWolverineXx** — *Mar 12 2007, 12:22 PM*

@Mjolnir\_Worthy no. That's not how movies work. Different directors, different casts. The Baker thing is just two friends who both needed work. Calm down.

**TWITTER** (*SXSW Interactive, Austin, TX. Twitter's usage explodes this week*)

**@geekdad\_atx** — *4:51 PM Mar 12th, 2007*

at SXSW, everyone twittering about twitter. meanwhile Iron Man started filming today and nobody here cares. wrong room.

## SCENE 2

INT. MARVEL STUDIOS — 9242 BEVERLY BLVD — SECOND FLOOR — DAY  
MONDAY, MARCH 12, 2007 — 10:15 AM PT

Downstairs, through the floor, a Mercedes salesman is closing a deal. Up here: cramped offices, a coffee maker from 1994, long boxes of comics stacked against every wall.

KEVIN FEIGE (33), Angels cap, Diet Coke, stands in front of a WHITEBOARD covered with taped-up butcher paper.

DAVID MAISEL (mid-40s, suit, no tie) comes in, starts to close the door, and stops. He points at the DOCUMENTARY CAMERA.

MAISEL

Kevin. Them?

FEIGE

Them.

MAISEL

In here?

FEIGE

Especially in here.

(to the camera, very polite)

Everything you film in this room  
is sealed. You signed the paper.  
Nobody sees it until 2019.

MAISEL

Why would we even—

FEIGE

Because if this works, somebody's  
going to want to know how it  
started. And if it doesn't...

(shrugs)

...it'll make a really good  
cautionary tale.

Maisel sighs, locks the door, and gives in.

MAISEL

Congratulations, Mr. President  
of Production.

FEIGE

Variety spelled my name right.  
That's a first.

MAISEL

Show me.

Feige tears the paper down.

Underneath: TEN CHARACTER NAMES, the Merrill Lynch collateral, plus IRON MAN, HULK, THOR, ANT-MAN and WASP in red marker. Arrows everywhere. All of them lead to one word circled three times in the middle:

AVENGERS

FEIGE

Eight films. Four and a half years. Every one of them stands on its own. You could walk into any of them cold and you'd love it.

(beat)

And every one of them is a chapter.

MAISEL

The bank thinks we're making one movie about a guy in a tin can.

FEIGE

The bank is right. For now.

MAISEL

Ike is going to ask what this costs.

FEIGE

It costs nothing extra. That's the trick. We're making these movies anyway. We just make them in the same world. Same S.H.I.E.L.D., same scientists, same timeline. Tony's repulsor tech exists in the Hulk movie. Nobody has to notice. Until they do.

Maisel steps closer and spots something in the lower-right corner of the board: a small sketch in purple marker.

A GAUNTLET. SIX EMPTY SLOTS.

The doc camera PUSHES IN on it. Feige notices and, without looking, flips a sheet of butcher paper down over it.

FEIGE (CONT'D)  
(to the camera)  
Not yet.

MAISEL  
What's under there?

FEIGE  
2019.

MAISEL  
(laughs)  
Kevin. We might not exist in  
2009.

FEIGE  
Then it won't matter.  
(beat)  
Rule one. Nobody outside this  
room says "universe." Not to  
agents, not to the trades, not  
to the actors. The contracts say  
"sequel options." The audience  
finds this on their own.

MAISEL  
And if they don't?

FEIGE  
They will. Fans always do.  
The first time Nick Fury walks  
into Tony Stark's living room,  
some kid on a message board is  
going to lose his mind. And then  
he's going to tell a million  
people.

MAISEL  
What's the project called?  
Internally.

Feige looks at the long boxes along the wall. Decades of Stan's  
Soapbox columns.

FEIGE  
Bullpen.

MAISEL  
Project Bullpen.

FEIGE  
Stan would like it.

Maisel heads for the door, then stops.

MAISEL  
One more thing. Avi.

FEIGE  
(quiet)  
I know.

MAISEL  
He built this place.

FEIGE  
And he's going to leave it in  
good hands. I'll make sure of  
that.

Maisel leaves. Feige looks at the camera for a long moment.

FEIGE (CONT'D)  
You didn't see the glove.

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## **TALKING HEAD**

INT. MARVEL STUDIOS — FEIGE'S OFFICE — DAY

LOWER THIRD: KEVIN FEIGE  
President of Production, Marvel Studios · Age 33

Angels cap. Diet Coke. Long boxes behind him.

FEIGE  
Every studio in town has asked  
to license our characters at  
some point. Spider-Man. The  
X-Men. The Fantastic Four. We  
said no every time. People  
thought we were crazy. People  
still think we're crazy.  
(beat)  
The comics have always been one  
world. Spider-Man swings past the  
Baxter Building. The Hulk is on  
the news in Daredevil's  
neighborhood. That's what makes  
Marvel, Marvel.  
(beat)  
So why would the movies be any

different?  
(small smile)  
That's all I'm going to say on  
camera. Even this camera.

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## SCENE 3

INT. FAVREAU'S PRODUCTION TRAILER — LONE PINE — NIGHT  
MONDAY, MARCH 12, 2007 — 8:40 PM PT

Storyboards everywhere. Favreau is eating cold craft-services  
pasta. His flip phone BUZZES. CALLER ID: "KEVIN F."

The DOC CAMERA is in the corner. Favreau glances at it, then  
puts the call on speaker.

FAVREAU  
Day one's in the can. Nobody died.  
Marc was in the suit for eleven  
takes.

FEIGE (V.O.)  
(over speaker)  
Eleven?

FAVREAU  
He refused to come out. Said Tony  
wouldn't come out. Then he did a  
seven-minute bit in the suit  
about a TSA agent that I can't  
ever let anyone hear. The grips  
were crying.

FEIGE (V.O.)  
That's why we hired him.  
(beat)  
Jon, I need an extra page.

FAVREAU  
We're locked. Paramount's got the  
script, the insurers have the  
script...

FEIGE (V.O.)  
It's not in the script. It goes  
after the credits.

Favreau puts his fork down.

FAVREAU

After the credits. Nobody stays  
for that. The ushers are sweeping  
popcorn.

FEIGE (V.O.)

They'll stay for this one.  
Samuel L. Jackson. Eye patch.  
Cigar. Tony's living room.

FAVREAU

(slow)

Nick Fury.

FEIGE (V.O.)

Jack Kirby's Fury. Sergeant of  
the Howling Commandos, Normandy,  
1944. The Infinity Formula keeps  
him in his fifties for sixty  
years. Every word of that  
history comes straight from  
the page.

FAVREAU

And Sam Jackson.

FEIGE (V.O.)

Sam Jackson is the one exception  
I'll ever make to the page. The  
history is 616. The face is Sam.  
Nobody else has that authority  
walking into a room.

FAVREAU

And he says what?

FEIGE (V.O.)

"I'm here to talk to you about  
the Avengers Initiative."

A long silence. Favreau slowly turns and looks straight into  
the doc camera.

FAVREAU

Kevin. There's a camera crew in  
my trailer.

FEIGE (V.O.)

I know. They're cleared.

FAVREAU

(to the camera)

...What are we making?

FEIGE (V.O.)

A great Iron Man movie. That's all it has to be.

(beat)

Skeleton crew. Fake slate. We'll call it...

(beat)

"Rhodey's Birthday Party." Nobody looks twice at that.

FAVREAU

(laughing)

Don's birthday is in November.

FEIGE (V.O.)

Then nobody will think it's real. Perfect.

Favreau hangs up. He writes on a napkin, "R.B.P. – N.F.", folds it, and puts it in his wallet. He looks at the camera.

FAVREAU

You're not allowed to film my wallet.

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## **SCENE 4**

INT. STAN LEE'S OFFICE – POW! ENTERTAINMENT – BEVERLY HILLS  
WEDNESDAY, MARCH 21, 2007 – 2:00 PM PT

STAN LEE (84), in tinted glasses, is signing a stack of posters with a black Sharpie. Feige sits across from him holding a single envelope.

STAN

(spotting the doc camera)

A camera crew! Kevin, you shouldn't have. Which is my good side? Trick question. They're both fantastic.

FEIGE

Your cameo. Iron Man.

STAN

Tell me I'm Hugh Hefner. I've been practicing.

FEIGE

(smiles)

Close.

(slides the envelope over)

And one more thing. Just for you.

Read it and give it back.

Stan opens it. One page. He reads it. His Sharpie stops moving.

STAN

(softly)

All of them.

FEIGE

All of them.

STAN

Same world. Like the comics. Like 1963. The Fantastic Four in the Baxter Building and Spidey swinging past the window and the Hulk on the news...

FEIGE

Every one of them, Stan. We never sold a single one. Not Spidey, not the X-Men, not the Four. Everybody's still home.

STAN

(grinning)

Every studio in town laughed at us for turning down their money. Let's see who's laughing in 2019.

(hands the page back)

You know what we called it in the '60s? The Marvel Universe. The fans named it. We didn't. The kids wrote letters: "Hey Stan, is this the same New York where Daredevil lives?" And we said, "True Believer... it always was."

FEIGE

That's the plan. They name it. Not us.

STAN

Excelsior, kid.

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## TALKING HEAD

INT. STAN LEE'S OFFICE — CONTINUOUS

LOWER THIRD: STAN LEE  
Co-Creator, Marvel Comics · Age 84

STAN  
I've heard a lot of pitches in  
sixty-five years. Most of them  
started with "What if we made it  
darker?" or "What if we made it  
like the other guy's?"  
(taps the table)  
This one was "What if we did it  
exactly the way you did it?"  
(beat)  
Nobody's ever pitched me that  
before.  
(leans into the camera)  
Face front, True Believers.  
Something's coming.

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## SCENE 5

INT. AMOND BAKER'S APARTMENT — INGLEWOOD, CA — NIGHT  
WEDNESDAY, APRIL 11, 2007 — 11:58 PM PT

A small one-bedroom. A framed Juilliard diploma leans against  
the wall because he never bought a nail. A poster for "Baker's  
Dozen" (cancelled) is taped over a water stain.

AMOND BAKER (25, looks 19) sits on the couch completely still,  
staring at a flip phone on the coffee table.

Next to him, still in fake-blood makeup from a night shoot,  
MARC-ANTHONY eats cereal out of the box.

MARC-ANTHONY  
It's gonna ring.

AMOND  
It's midnight.

MARC-ANTHONY  
Kevin said the announcement's in  
the morning. They'll call before  
the trades get it. That's how it

works.

AMOND

You don't know how it works.

MARC-ANTHONY

I have a 250 IQ.

AMOND

You have a 250 IQ and you're eating Froot Loops out of the box with your hand at midnight.

MARC-ANTHONY

Those aren't mutually exclusive, Amond.

Silence. The phone doesn't ring. Amond's jaw tightens and his hands grip his knees. The doc camera catches it: something building under the calm.

MARC-ANTHONY (CONT'D)

(softer)

Hey. Look at me.

(Amond does)

You went to Juilliard at twenty when everybody told you to do another sitcom. You did the hard thing. You always do the hard thing. They saw your tape. Nobody watches your tape and says no.

AMOND

Nine months, Marc.

MARC-ANTHONY

Fourteen for me. You're catching up. Don't get cocky.

Amond almost laughs.

The phone RINGS. Both of them jump. Cereal goes everywhere.

Amond stares at the caller ID. "MARVEL STUDIOS." He can't move.

MARC-ANTHONY (CONT'D)

ANSWER IT. ANSWER THE [BLEEP]—

AMOND

(answering, very calm)

This is Amond.

(listens)

...Yes.  
    (listens)  
...Yes, sir.  
    (listens; his eyes fill)  
Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Feige.

He hangs up and sets the phone down very carefully, like it's made of glass. He looks at Marc-Anthony.

                    AMOND (CONT'D)  
I'm Bruce Banner.

Marc-Anthony SCREAMS, tackles him off the couch, and they go down in a pile of Froot Loops.

The upstairs neighbor BANGS on the ceiling.

                    MARC-ANTHONY  
                    (to the ceiling)  
HE'S THE HULK, DEBORAH!

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## **TALKING HEAD**

INT. AMOND BAKER'S APARTMENT — LATER

LOWER THIRD: AMOND BAKER  
Actor, "Bruce Banner" · Age 25

There's still a Froot Loop in his hair. His voice is quiet and even.

                    AMOND  
People think Banner is about the anger. It's not. It's about how much work it takes to keep it down. Every day. Being polite. Being small. Being who they need you to be so nobody gets scared.  
                    (beat)  
I've been doing that my whole career.  
                    (small smile)  
Now I get to let it out.  
                    (beat)  
Marc cried more than I did. Put that in.

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## MEDIA INSERT: SPRING 2007

**VARIETY** | Thursday, April 12, 2007

### **AMOND BAKER TO PLAY BRUCE BANNER IN 'THE INCREDIBLE HULK'; PARAMOUNT DISTRIBS**

*Juilliard-trained former 'SPLAT!' star lands his first dramatic lead. Leterrier helms the first live-action Hulk film, Toronto summer start. Marvel promises "the Hulk from the comics, with no limits on how strong he gets."*

**SUPERHEROHYPE FORUMS** | April 12, 2007, 9:03 AM

**XxWolverineXx:** ok. Bullock AND Baker. Two SPLAT! kids. Two Marvel movies. Same year. ...fine. I'm a little worried now.

**AIN'T IT COOL NEWS** | April 30, 2007

### **Moriarty here with a WHISPER from the Iron Man set...**

*A little birdie says a "mystery day" is on the call sheet with a crew of about 12 people and a code name about a birthday party. Marvel won't comment. Somebody's cooking something, squirts.*

**THE HOLLYWOOD REPORTER** | Thursday, May 31, 2007

### **ARAD EXITS MARVEL STUDIOS**

*Founder steps down to produce independently. Chairman Maisel and production chief Feige to steer the studio's slate.*

**COMICBOOKRESOURCES.COM** | May 31, 2007

### **THE END OF AN ERA: What Arad's departure means for Marvel's movies**

*"Feige is the guy who knows the difference between Earth-616 and Earth-1610," said one source. "Fans should be very, very happy."*

## SCENE 6 (CLOSING)

INT. MARVEL STUDIOS — FEIGE'S OFFICE — NIGHT  
THURSDAY, MAY 31, 2007 — 11:52 PM PT

The building is empty. The Mercedes showroom below is dark. The doc camera sits on a tripod in the corner, unmanned, still rolling.

FEIGE (33) is alone. AVI ARAD's farewell card is propped on the desk: "Don't screw up my toys. — Avi."

Feige unlocks a bottom drawer and takes out a three-ring binder.

Hand-lettered on the spine:

THE CODEX

The first tab: IRON MAN — MAY 2, 2008.

The last tab is blank except for a date:

MAY 2019

He picks up a purple marker and writes one line on the blank page. We can't read it from here.

He closes the binder and locks the drawer. On his way out he stops at the tripod, looks into the lens, and reaches for the record button.

FEIGE

Goodnight.

CUT TO BLACK.

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## **TAG: TALKING HEAD**

INT. PRODUCTION TRAILER — LONE PINE — NIGHT  
(RECORDED MARCH 12, 2007 — 11:14 PM PT)

LOWER THIRD: MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK  
Actor, "Tony Stark" · Age 25

Out of costume. Hoodie. Exhausted. Bruises on his shoulders from the Mark I straps. For the first time, no joke is ready.

MARC-ANTHONY

What if it flops?

(beat)

Like, really. Not a funny question. If this flops, I'm the Brainiac kid forever. That's the headline on my... on my everything.

(long pause)

But then I think... I want kids. A lot of kids. Like, a ridiculous amount. A basketball team. Two basketball teams.

(smiles)

And one day one of them is gonna find this movie. And they're gonna look at me in that suit and

go, "Daddy did that?"  
    (beat)  
So it can't flop.  
    (beat)  
...Somebody's getting named  
Brenda.

CUT TO BLACK.

SUPER:  
"11 MONTHS UNTIL IRON MAN OPENS."

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**END OF CHAPTER ONE (DRAFT). 🔒 Our story has NOT started.**